

FACTSHEET FS03 · Momentum

What changed on 2 October 2026. Two corrections, both to the universe of stocks, and every number below is re-run on them. (1) **US:** the universe is now the actual S&P 500 members at each month-end. Until now it was the 500 largest of every company that was *ever* in the index 2012–2026, which includes later winners before they joined. (2) **UK and EU:** the price panels now include the index members that stopped trading (UK coverage of members 71% → 92%, EU 81% → 89%); before, most of them had no prices. SCANDI stays as registered (OMXC25 + OMXS30 + OMXH25). Registered verdicts are unchanged; where a corrected number crosses a gate, the text says so. Comparison and method: FACTSHEETS_RERUN_2026-10-02.md.

US, 1999–2012 (pre-registered second period, run 2 October 2026). The same rules on Sharadar's point-in-time S&P 500 with delisted stocks, 1999–2012, a period this factsheet was not built on. L/S net: $t - 0.36$ (2013–2026: $+0.31$), no 2013–2026 effect to test. Long-only alpha vs the equal-weight universe: $+0.3\%$ a year, $t + 0.06$ (2013–2026: $+1.74$), same sign, weaker. US momentum shows nothing in 1999–2012, a period that includes the 2009 momentum crash. Registered verdicts are unchanged. Pre-registration, method and every result: PREREG_US_1999_2012.md.

Buy last year's winners, sell last year's losers

Henrik Gjerming · Rude Investment Consulting · Project 10 sidebar: strategy factsheets · data to 31 August 2026

STRATEGY	ORIGIN	FAMILY
Cross-sectional momentum (Carhart's UMD, AQR's momentum)	Jegadeesh & Titman (1993)	Momentum & trend
UNIVERSES	BACKTEST	BOOKS
US · EU · UK · DK · SCANDI · World (point-in-time)	Feb 2013 – Aug 2026, monthly, net of costs	Long/short and long-only (winners)
REBALANCE	STATUS	
Monthly	Descriptive factsheet, not a registered trial	

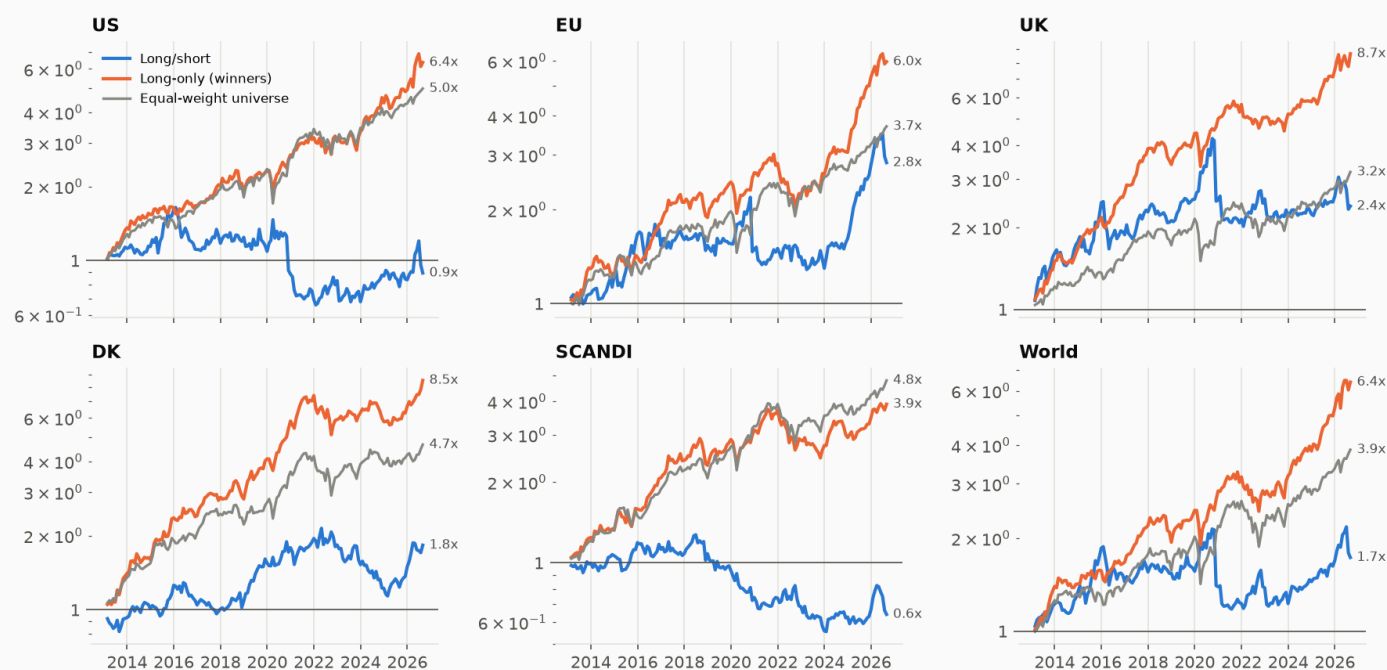
The claim. Stocks that did best over the past year keep outperforming the worst over the next months. Jegadeesh & Titman (1993) found about 1% a month for US stocks in 1965–1989; Asness, Moskowitz & Pedersen (2013) found it in every major equity market and asset class. **What we find, 2013–2026, point-in-time universes, after costs:** the long/short earned -2.1% to $+9.8\%$ a year and was positive in 5 of the six; no universe passes the 2.87 gate. The long-only book (winners) had a higher Sharpe than the equal-weight universe in 5 of the six (US, EU, UK, DK, World), with alphas of $+0.2\%$ to $+9.0\%$, passing the gate in UK, World. **What goes wrong (§10):** the main drags are a market bet (average beta -0.38 , worth -4.5% a year in 2013–19), a weaker second half (2020–26). None of the pre-declared fixes passes the gate in both windows. **Classification (§11):** Momentum & trend; its returns sit closest to the momentum cluster of the signal library. **360° view (§12):** nearest neighbours Near 52-week high, Volatility; after its closest neighbours and the market it keeps an alpha of -3.9% to $+7.2\%$ (largest $|t|$ 2.2), so it carries some information of its own.

1. Headline performance

Universe	Names / groups	L/S return / yr	L/S t	L/S CAPM alpha (t)	L/S beta	Long-only CAGR	Long-only Sharpe	Long-only max DD	EW CAGR	EW Sharpe	Size-weighted CAGR
US	501 / 10	+1.7%	0.31	+9.8% (2.4)	-0.62	+14.6%	0.87	-20%	+12.6%	0.85	+14.9%
EU	264 / 10	+9.8%	1.93	+16.7% (3.6)	-0.64	+14.1%	0.96	-33%	+10.1%	0.75	+10.2%
UK	324 / 10	+9.3%	1.52	+15.6% (3.0)	-0.66	+17.2%	1.13	-25%	+8.9%	0.68	+7.8%
DK	20 / 3	+5.9%	1.29	+9.4% (2.1)	-0.28	+17.1%	1.07	-31%	+12.0%	0.83	+10.2%
SCANDI	70 / 5	-2.1%	-0.54	+2.1% (0.6)	-0.34	+10.5%	0.76	-34%	+12.2%	0.89	+11.0%
World	1086 / 10	+6.1%	1.22	+12.9% (3.5)	-0.60	+14.6%	0.94	-25%	+10.5%	0.71	+10.3%

Monthly, local currency (World in USD). L/S = equal-weighted winners (highest 12-1 return) minus losers (lowest 12-1 return), net of 10 bp per side on turnover, a size-tiered borrow fee on the short leg and, where the book is net long cash, financing at the USD risk-free rate + 0.5%. Newey-West t (6 lags). CAPM vs the equal-weight universe. Size-weighted universe = market-cap weights in the US, traded-value weights elsewhere (a proxy for the index).

Momentum on six stock universes, 2013-2026



Growth of 1, log scale, local currency, net of costs. Henrik Gjering · Project 10 factsheets

2. Strategy description

Stocks that did best over the past year keep outperforming the worst over the next months. Jegadeesh & Titman (1993) found about 1% a month for US stocks in 1965–1989; Asness, Moskowitz & Pedersen (2013) found it in every major equity market and asset class.

Why it might work. Behavioural: investors under-react to news and then herd (Barberis, Shleifer & Vishny 1998; Hong & Stein 1999); the disposition effect slows the price response (Grinblatt & Han 2005). Risk stories exist but explain little.

Rule	Original (Jegadeesh & Titman (1993))	This factsheet
Signal	Past 3–12 month return; the classic 12-1 skips the latest month	Return from month t–11 to t–1 (skip month t)
Portfolio	Decile or tercile long/short, 1–12 month holding	Extreme quantile L/S, one-month holding, monthly rebalance
Weighting	Equal or value weighted	Equal weighted

3. Data load

Universe	Prices	Membership	Names eligible (median)	Currency
US	Sharadar SEP ccloseadj (total return), 805 tickers incl. delisted	Point-in-time: the S&P 500 members at each month-end (Sharadar add/remove history; corrected 2 Oct 2026)	~503	USD
EU	Project1 yfinance cache, Adj Close (TR)	Point-in-time: union of 11 national blue-chip indices (CAC 40, DAX, AEX, IBEX 35, FTSE MIB, OMXS30, OMXC25, OMXH25, BEL 20, PSI-20, WIG20), quarterly Wikipedia snapshots 2012–2026; 83% of member-quarters priced	~238	local (EUR, SEK, DKK, PLN)
UK	Project1 cache, Close + pence dividends (Yahoo under-adjusts LSE ~100×)	Point-in-time: FTSE 100 + FTSE 250, quarterly snapshots; 75% priced	~242	GBP
DK	Project1 cache, Adj Close	Point-in-time: OMX Copenhagen 25, quarterly snapshots; 91% priced	~19	DKK
SCANDI	Project1 cache, Adj Close	Point-in-time: OMXC25 + OMXS30 + OMXH25 (Oslo has no snapshot history); 88% priced	~62	local (DKK, SEK, EUR)
World	US Sharadar + UK + EU above	Point-in-time union of the three; local-currency returns summed, not converted	~963	mixed

Membership comes from Project2's cache of dated Wikipedia index pages (the same parsing as run_wiki_pit.py / run_eu_pit.py), with a short list of verified ticker renames (e.g. NZYM-B → NSIS-B, WDH → DEMANT, DAI → MBG). A name is eligible from the day after the snapshot that lists it, once it has 60 days of prices. Member-

quarters without a price are mostly delisted names that Yahoo no longer serves, so some survivorship remains; see §13.

4. Signal creation

$MOM_{i,t} = P_{i,t-1} / P_{i,t-12} - 1$ on total-return prices; the most recent month is skipped to avoid the one-month reversal. Signals use only information up to month-end t and are traded in month $t+1$. Eligibility: in the point-in-time universe on any of the last five trading days of month t .

5. Model build

- Sort eligible stocks into equal-count groups (deciles ≥ 100 names, quintiles 50–99, terciles < 50 ; fixed per universe).
- **Long/short** = winners (highest 12-1 return) minus losers (lowest 12-1 return); **long-only** = winners (highest 12-1 return); benchmarks: equal-weight universe and size-weighted universe.
- Equal weights within each leg, rebalanced monthly.
- Costs: 10 bp per side on the one-way turnover of each leg; short-leg borrow fee 0.25% / 0.75% / 2% a year by size tier (largest 50% / next 30% / smallest 20% of the universe, `code/borrow.py`); net long cash financed at the USD risk-free rate + 0.5%. Code: `code/xs.py` (engine), `code/analyse_xs.py`, `code/build_xs.py`.

6. Performance in detail

US (S&P 500 members, point-in-time), median 501 names, 10 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	+1.7%	-0.9%	22.2%	0.08 [-0.39, 0.53]	-0.05	-60%	53%	0.31	-0.62	+9.8% (2.4)	15.2%
Long-only (net)	+15.2%	+14.6%	17.4%	0.87 [0.49, 1.31]	1.46	-20%	60%	4.55	0.90	+3.4% (1.7)	9.7%
Winners (gross)	+15.9%	+15.4%	17.4%	0.92 [0.53, 1.36]	1.56	-20%	61%	4.77	0.90	+4.1% (2.1)	9.6%
Losers (gross)	+11.7%	+8.5%	26.7%	0.44 [0.00, 0.93]	0.51	-46%	58%	1.87	1.52	-8.2% (-2.9)	15.1%
EW universe	+13.1%	+12.6%	15.5%	0.85 [0.41, 1.42]	1.29	-28%	67%	4.20	1.00	–	9.2%
Size-weighted universe	+14.9%	+14.9%	14.2%	1.05 [0.60, 1.61]	1.73	-24%	69%	5.29	0.86	+3.7% (2.4)	8.3%

EU (11 national blue-chip indices, point-in-time), median 264 names, 10 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	+9.8%	+8.0%	19.9%	0.49 [0.01, 1.09]	0.56	-41%	61%	1.93	-0.64	+16.7% (3.6)	13.0%
Long-only (net)	+14.3%	+14.1%	15.0%	0.96 [0.37, 1.64]	1.54	-33%	63%	3.22	0.81	+5.6% (1.9)	8.3%
Winners (gross)	+15.0%	+14.9%	15.0%	1.00 [0.42, 1.69]	1.65	-32%	64%	3.38	0.81	+6.3% (2.1)	8.3%
Losers (gross)	+3.0%	+0.3%	23.7%	0.13 [-0.36, 0.58]	0.02	-45%	48%	0.51	1.46	-12.6% (-4.3)	12.5%
EW universe	+10.7%	+10.1%	14.3%	0.75 [0.29, 1.30]	1.14	-26%	61%	3.18	1.00	–	8.4%
Size-weighted universe	+10.6%	+10.2%	13.7%	0.77 [0.32, 1.29]	1.21	-25%	58%	3.37	0.92	+0.8% (0.6)	7.9%

UK (FTSE 350, point-in-time), median 324 names, 10 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	+9.3%	+6.6%	22.9%	0.41 [-0.07, 0.98]	0.39	-52%	61%	1.52	-0.66	+15.6% (3.0)	16.4%
Long-only (net)	+17.2%	+17.2%	15.2%	1.13 [0.58, 1.80]	1.90	-25%	66%	4.46	0.86	+9.0% (3.7)	9.1%
Winners (gross)	+17.8%	+18.0%	15.2%	1.17 [0.62, 1.85]	2.00	-25%	66%	4.63	0.86	+9.6% (4.0)	9.0%
Losers (gross)	+6.6%	+3.4%	25.7%	0.26 [-0.21, 0.73]	0.21	-49%	52%	0.97	1.51	-7.9% (-2.4)	14.6%
EW universe	+9.6%	+8.9%	14.1%	0.68 [0.19, 1.28]	0.96	-30%	58%	2.87	1.00	–	8.8%
Size-weighted universe	+8.4%	+7.8%	12.9%	0.65 [0.16, 1.25]	0.90	-28%	62%	2.68	0.84	+0.3% (0.2)	7.8%

DK (OMXC25, point-in-time), median 20 names, 3 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	+5.9%	+4.5%	17.3%	0.34 [-0.18, 0.85]	0.39	-47%	55%	1.29	-0.28	+9.4% (2.1)	10.6%
Long-only (net)	+17.1%	+17.1%	16.0%	1.07 [0.49, 1.68]	1.95	-31%	63%	3.98	0.90	+5.9% (2.6)	7.7%
Winners (gross)	+17.5%	+17.6%	16.0%	1.10 [0.52, 1.71]	2.01	-31%	64%	4.08	0.90	+6.3% (2.8)	7.7%
Losers (gross)	+9.9%	+8.1%	20.6%	0.48 [0.00, 1.03]	0.60	-45%	62%	1.96	1.17	-4.8% (-1.8)	12.2%

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
EW universe	+12.6%	+12.0%	15.2%	0.83 [0.31, 1.44]	1.27	-33%	66%	3.31	1.00	–	8.8%
Size-weighted universe	+11.1%	+10.2%	16.4%	0.68 [0.11, 1.33]	0.94	-40%	62%	2.55	0.93	-0.6% (-0.2)	10.7%

SCANDI (OMXC25 + OMXS30 + OMXH25, point-in-time), median 70 names, 5 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	-2.1%	-3.2%	15.0%	-0.14 [-0.62, 0.35]	-0.28	-56%	50%	-0.54	-0.34	+2.1% (0.6)	9.9%
Long-only (net)	+11.1%	+10.5%	14.7%	0.76 [0.21, 1.36]	1.15	-34%	63%	2.83	0.87	+0.2% (0.1)	8.4%
Winners (gross)	+11.7%	+11.2%	14.7%	0.80 [0.25, 1.40]	1.24	-33%	63%	2.98	0.87	+0.8% (0.4)	8.3%
Losers (gross)	+11.9%	+10.6%	19.2%	0.62 [0.12, 1.18]	0.88	-43%	58%	2.45	1.21	-3.3% (-1.4)	11.5%
EW universe	+12.6%	+12.2%	14.2%	0.89 [0.37, 1.51]	1.38	-29%	66%	3.63	1.00	–	8.4%
Size-weighted universe	+11.4%	+11.0%	13.5%	0.84 [0.37, 1.41]	1.32	-26%	63%	3.59	0.90	+0.0% (0.0)	8.1%

World (US + UK + EU, point-in-time), median 1086 names, 10 groups

Book	Mean / yr	CAGR	Vol	Sharpe [95% CI]	Sortino	Max DD	Hit	t(mean)	Beta	Alpha/yr (t)	CVaR 95% (month)
L/S (net)	+6.1%	+4.1%	19.4%	0.31 [-0.16, 0.87]	0.28	-45%	58%	1.22	-0.60	+12.9% (3.5)	14.0%
Long-only (net)	+15.0%	+14.6%	15.9%	0.94 [0.46, 1.51]	1.55	-25%	63%	4.04	0.86	+5.3% (3.0)	9.2%
Winners (gross)	+15.7%	+15.4%	15.9%	0.99 [0.51, 1.55]	1.65	-25%	63%	4.23	0.86	+6.0% (3.4)	9.1%
Losers (gross)	+7.4%	+4.2%	25.8%	0.29 [-0.18, 0.77]	0.26	-45%	53%	1.13	1.46	-9.1% (-3.7)	14.0%
EW universe	+11.3%	+10.5%	16.0%	0.71 [0.25, 1.28]	1.02	-30%	63%	3.07	1.00	–	9.7%
Size-weighted universe	+11.0%	+10.3%	14.8%	0.74 [0.28, 1.31]	1.10	-28%	61%	3.19	0.91	+0.7% (0.8)	8.9%

Sharpe CI: stationary bootstrap (mean block 6 months, 5,000 draws). Max drawdown on monthly returns.

Calendar-year returns, L/S (net)

Year	US	EU	UK	DK	SCANDI	World
2013	+12.1%	+7.6%	+60.8%	-7.0%	-0.2%	+22.4%
2014	+1.7%	+13.9%	+10.2%	+8.6%	+6.5%	+9.5%
2015	+41.4%	+36.5%	+39.1%	+24.6%	+12.0%	+38.6%
2016	-31.2%	-8.2%	-23.8%	-16.8%	-5.7%	-22.2%
2017	+6.0%	+4.4%	+21.3%	-3.7%	-3.6%	+7.6%
2018	+5.7%	-4.2%	-7.0%	+7.7%	-0.0%	-0.8%
2019	-12.3%	+1.4%	+19.8%	+42.6%	-13.4%	+1.4%
2020	-19.2%	-4.1%	-0.9%	+15.5%	-20.7%	-10.9%
2021	-21.1%	+0.6%	-14.9%	+9.0%	-0.5%	-11.8%
2022	+19.3%	-5.9%	+18.9%	-6.0%	-7.1%	+12.4%
2023	-18.0%	-8.2%	-13.5%	-16.8%	-18.8%	-11.1%
2024	+27.4%	+24.6%	+1.5%	-19.9%	+12.7%	+17.7%
2025	-3.6%	+72.6%	+16.4%	+22.3%	+6.6%	+17.1%
2026	+6.6%	+1.5%	-8.0%	+22.3%	-4.1%	+2.3%

Calendar-year returns, long-only (net)

Year	US	EU	UK	DK	SCANDI	World
2013	+35.9%	+29.4%	+50.6%	+40.4%	+24.3%	+39.7%
2014	+13.0%	-4.7%	+11.1%	+13.7%	+6.3%	+1.8%
2015	+6.5%	+14.4%	+30.1%	+47.9%	+20.0%	+10.4%
2016	+2.2%	+28.4%	+23.5%	+2.0%	+30.7%	+6.5%
2017	+19.8%	+16.6%	+44.7%	+18.7%	+16.2%	+31.4%
2018	-6.4%	-10.5%	-12.7%	-1.6%	-4.2%	-11.7%
2019	+22.9%	+30.0%	+30.2%	+45.6%	+25.0%	+26.9%
2020	+16.6%	+7.1%	+13.0%	+42.3%	+8.5%	+15.5%
2021	+17.5%	+7.1%	+12.9%	+27.0%	+18.6%	+11.1%
2022	-3.0%	-20.5%	-10.5%	-20.2%	-22.8%	-12.3%
2023	+8.9%	+16.3%	+3.1%	+6.7%	-4.4%	+14.9%
2024	+31.0%	+17.5%	+10.8%	-8.2%	+7.0%	+20.2%
2025	+12.9%	+74.6%	+31.0%	+15.5%	+18.8%	+38.0%
2026	+29.2%	+11.8%	+14.6%	+27.4%	+12.1%	+21.2%

7. Trading record

The rebalance log per universe is in `results/xs_F503_record_<universe>.csv` (names per leg, turnover, leg returns, gross and net L/S).

Universe	Rebalances	Names long / short	Turnover long leg / month	Turnover short leg / month	L/S months positive	Worst L/S month	When
US	163	51 / 50	30%	26%	53%	-27.6%	2020-11
EU	163	27 / 26	29%	24%	61%	-33.1%	2020-11
UK	163	33 / 32	28%	26%	61%	-40.1%	2020-11
DK	163	7 / 6	17%	19%	55%	-14.1%	2022-05
SCANDI	163	14 / 14	25%	24%	50%	-14.8%	2018-11
World	163	109 / 108	29%	25%	58%	-34.0%	2020-11

Current book (signal at 31 August 2026; first 8 names per leg)

Universe	Long: winners	Short: losers
US	SNDK, MU, WDC, LITE, STX, CIEN, INTC, DELL	CSGP, TTD, FISV, BSX, BLDR, INTU, COIN, PODD
EU	KGH.WA, ASML.AS, MT.AS, MTS.MC, REP.MC, ASM.AS, TYRES.HE, NOKIA.HE	ONTEX.BR, AGFB.BR, QTCOM.HE, UMG.AS, GTC.WA, BAR.BR, ADYEN.AS, STLAM.MI
UK	SAGA.L, CMCX.L, CWR.L, KLR.L, WOSG.L, SSIT.L, CCC.L, APN.L	VTY.L, AML.L, TEP.L, MEGP.L, BCG.L, DATA.L, ONT.L, ENT.L
DK	DANSKE.CO, ISS.CO, JYSK.CO, NKT.CO, VWS.CO, MAERSK-B.CO, NDA-DK.CO, MAERSK-A.CO	ZEAL.CO, COLO-B.CO, ORSTED.CO, BAVA.CO, AMBU-B.CO, GN.CO, ROCK-B.CO, NOVO-B.CO
SCANDI	NOKIA.HE, TYRES.HE, NESTE.HE, DANSKE.CO, JYSK.CO, SWED-A.ST, SAND.ST, ISS.CO	QTCOM.HE, ORSTED.CO, COLO-B.CO, BAVA.CO, PNDORA.CO, AMBU-B.CO, GN.CO, ELISA.HE

8. Risk and factor attribution

JKP 7 themes (US, UK, DK, World) or French Europe 5F + WML (EU, SCANDI); Newey-West t, 6 lags.

Long/short

Universe	Factor model	Alpha / yr	t(alpha)	R ²	Loadings with t ≥ 2 (t)
US	JKP USA 7 themes	-4.6%	-1.80	0.81	value -0.62 (-5.4), momentum +1.51 (+11.3)

Universe	Factor model	Alpha / yr	t(alpha)	R ²	Loadings with t ≥ 2 (t)
EU	French Europe 5F + WML	-4.1%	-1.42	0.66	WML +1.50 (+13.8)
UK	JKP GBR 7 themes	+2.4%	0.61	0.68	momentum +1.22 (+7.0), low_risk +0.94 (+3.1), quality +0.94 (+2.3)
DK	JKP DNK 7 themes	-3.5%	-1.14	0.55	size -0.29 (-2.7), momentum +1.14 (+11.9), quality +0.28 (+2.5), short_term_reversal +0.27 (+2.5)
SCANDI	French Europe 5F + WML	-10.4%	-2.88	0.35	WML +0.85 (+7.6)
World	JKP World 7 themes	+2.8%	0.64	0.63	value -0.53 (-3.3), momentum +1.26 (+9.2)

Long-only

Universe	Factor model	Alpha / yr	t(alpha)	R ²	Loadings with t ≥ 2 (t)
US	JKP USA 7 themes	+0.9%	0.64	0.90	mkt +0.96 (+23.5), size -0.41 (-3.8), momentum +0.79 (+9.8), low_risk -0.31 (-4.3)
EU	French Europe 5F + WML	+3.1%	1.00	0.56	Mkt-RF +0.75 (+13.3), WML +0.53 (+6.2)
UK	JKP GBR 7 themes	+8.1%	3.78	0.70	mkt +0.57 (+11.6), momentum +0.65 (+6.8), low_risk -0.59 (-4.6), quality +0.69 (+4.3)
DK	JKP DNK 7 themes	+5.8%	2.23	0.68	mkt +0.68 (+15.9), size -0.18 (-2.4), momentum +0.36 (+4.0), low_risk -0.46 (-5.3), quality +0.31 (+3.2)
SCANDI	French Europe 5F + WML	+2.5%	0.72	0.48	Mkt-RF +0.65 (+9.2), WML +0.28 (+3.5)
World	JKP World 7 themes	+6.5%	2.76	0.77	mkt +0.69 (+11.6), momentum +0.61 (+6.9)

9. Statistical verdict

- **Gate:** $|t| > 2.87$ (2 books $\times$ 6 universes, Bonferroni 0.05/12, two-sided).
- **L/S mean:** positive in 5 of the six; passes in 0 of 6.
- **L/S CAPM alpha:** +2.1% to +16.7%, $|t|$ past the gate in 3 of 6.
- **Long-only:** Sharpe above the equal-weight universe in 5 of the six; alpha +0.2% to +9.0%, passing in 2 of 6.
- **Probabilistic Sharpe** of the L/S, $P(\text{true Sharpe} > 0)$: US 0.61, EU 0.95, UK 0.91, DK 0.89, SCANDI 0.30, World 0.86.
- **Publication decay:** gross L/S +2.0% to +17.5% a year in 2013–19 against -2.5% to +13.8% in 2020–26.

10. What goes wrong, and how to fix it

Method. Diagnose on the design window (2013–2019); apply the same pre-declared fix ladder used for every sort strategy in FSO3–FS12; judge on the holdout (Jan 2020 – Aug 2026) with a pooled six-universe paired bootstrap of the Sharpe difference against the previous step. 25 fix trials across FSO3–FS12, gate $p < 0.0020$.

10.1 Diagnosis (design window 2013–2019)

Universe	L/S gross / yr	Beta	Beta drag / yr	CAPM alpha (gross)	Costs / yr	Long leg vs EW / yr	EW vs short leg / yr	Turnover / month	Worst months
US	+5.5%	-0.57	-7.5%	+13.0%	-1.3%	+0.6%	+4.9%	56%	2015-04 -13%, 2016-04 -12%, 2016-03 -10%
EU	+10.3%	-0.58	-6.2%	+16.5%	-1.3%	+4.1%	+6.3%	55%	2016-12 -11%, 2015-02 -10%, 2016-03 -10%
UK	+17.5%	-0.43	-5.0%	+22.4%	-1.3%	+11.5%	+6.0%	52%	2016-02 -17%, 2016-04 -14%, 2013-08 -13%
DK	+9.1%	0.01	+0.2%	+9.0%	-0.9%	+6.7%	+2.5%	36%	2018-11 -13%, 2013-08 -10%, 2013-02 -8%
SCANDI	+2.0%	-0.18	-2.7%	+4.8%	-1.2%	+1.8%	+0.2%	50%	2018-11 -15%, 2015-04 -9%, 2017-05 -8%
World	+10.0%	-0.54	-5.8%	+15.8%	-1.3%	+3.6%	+6.4%	54%	2016-04 -12%, 2015-04 -11%, 2016-03 -8%

On average across the six universes the gross spread was +9.1% a year, of which the market exposure (beta -0.38) contributed -4.5%; the beta-adjusted spread (CAPM alpha) was +13.6%. Costs took 1.2% a year at 51% monthly turnover across both legs. The long leg beat the universe by +4.7% and the short leg lagged it by +4.4% a year, so most of the spread comes from the long side. Holding longer does not change the picture much: the gross spread 2, 3 and 6 months after formation averages +6.4%, +6.6%, +5.9% a year.

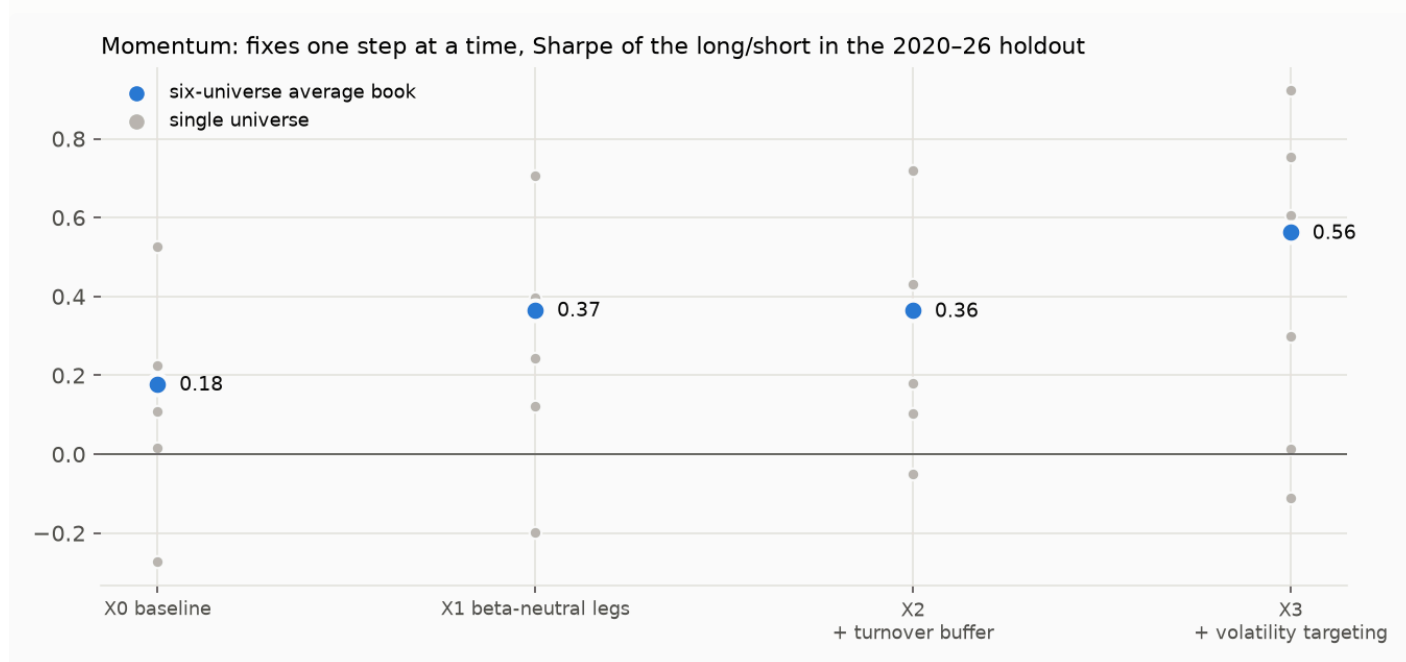
10.2 The fix ladder

X0 baseline → X1 **beta-neutral legs** (each leg scaled by 1/its ex-ante beta) → X2 + **turnover buffer** (enter the extreme 1/q, keep a name until it leaves the extreme 3/q) → X3 + **volatility targeting** (scale the L/S to 10% a year using its trailing 6-month volatility, lagged; Barroso & Santa-Clara 2015; Moreira & Muir 2017).

Step	Design Sharpe (avg)	Δ design (p)	Holdout Sharpe (book)	Δ holdout (p)	Universes improved	Holdout return / yr	Holdout max DD	Holdout alpha vs EW (t)	Costs / yr
X0 baseline	0.39	–	0.18	–	–	+3.2%	-37%	+9.7% (2.0)	1.2%

Step	Design Sharpe (avg)	Δ design (p)	Holdout Sharpe (book)	Δ holdout (p)	Universes improved	Holdout return / yr	Holdout max DD	Holdout alpha vs EW (t)	Costs / yr
X1 beta-neutral legs	0.55	+0.23 (p 0.022)	0.37	+0.19 (p 0.080)	6 of 6	+4.8%	-25%	+7.6% (1.7)	1.3%
X2 + turnover buffer	0.54	-0.02 (p 0.559)	0.36	-0.00 (p 0.493)	4 of 6	+4.3%	-26%	+6.8% (1.6)	0.6%
X3 + volatility targeting	0.43	-0.16 (p 0.648)	0.56	+0.20 (p 0.009)	4 of 6	+5.8%	-17%	+7.9% (2.1)	0.6%

✓ = passes the gate in the holdout. Design Sharpe = average across universes; tests and holdout columns use the six-universe equal-weighted book.



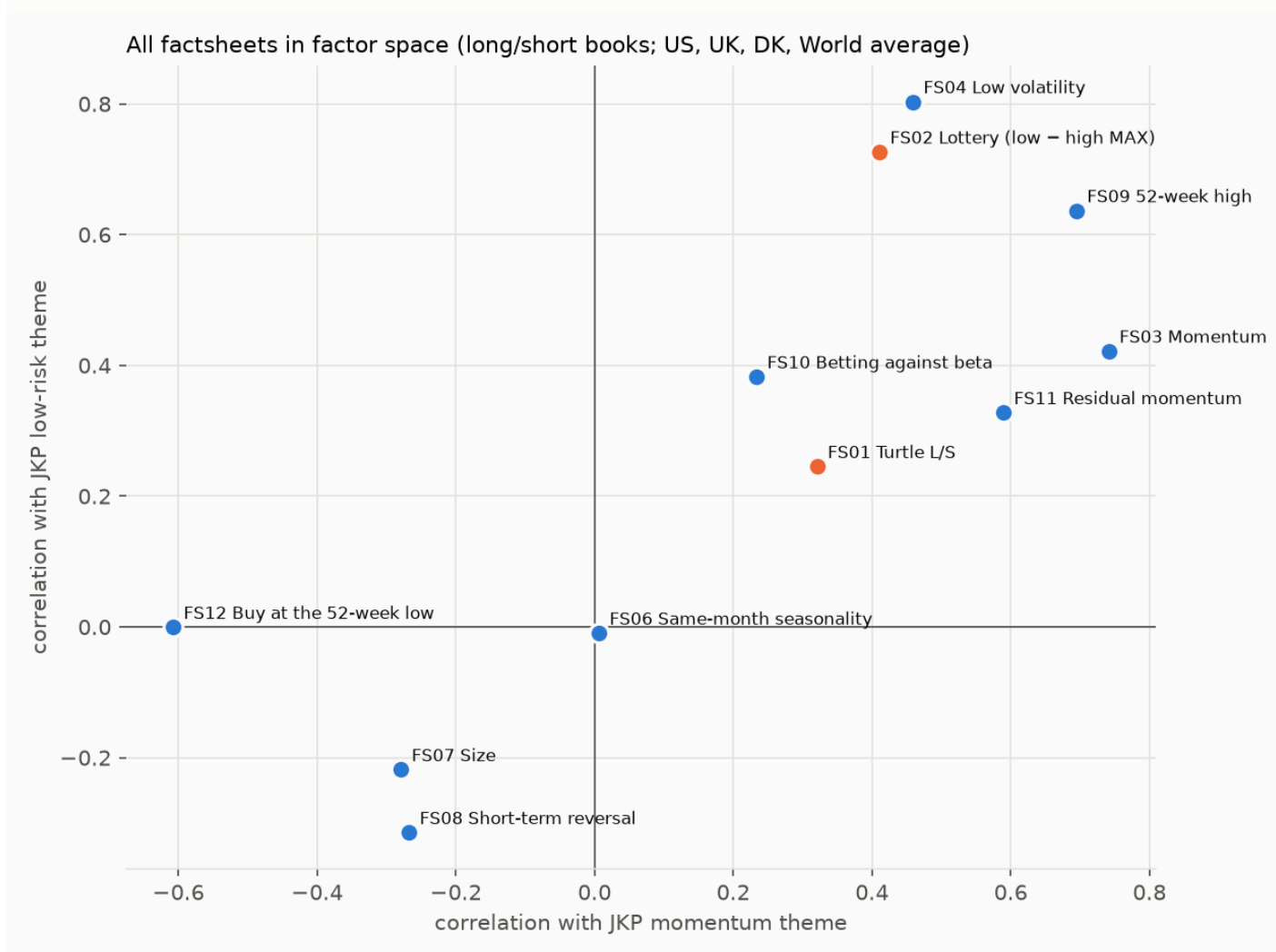
- **X1 beta-neutral legs:** +0.23 design, +0.19 holdout; helps in both windows but does not pass the gate.
- **X2 + turnover buffer:** -0.02 design, -0.00 holdout; hurts in both windows.
- **X3 + volatility targeting:** -0.16 design, +0.20 holdout; helps in one window and hurts in the other: not reliable.

Where it ends: holdout Sharpe 0.18 → 0.56, return +3.2% → +5.8% a year (six-universe book).

11. Classification: where does it fit?

Dimension	Momentum
Series family	Momentum & trend
Academic style	Cross-sectional momentum (Carhart's UMD, AQR's momentum)
Signal	Price only (daily total returns)

Dimension	Momentum
Cross-section vs time series	Cross-sectional: stocks ranked against each other each month
Horizon and turnover	One month; 51% of the two legs replaced monthly
Market exposure	L/S beta -0.66 to -0.28
Payoff shape	Treynor–Mazuy γ -3.73 to 0.43 (t -2.2 to 0.5); worst 10% of market months +2.5% to +4.5% a month, best 10% -6.1% to -2.2%
Nearest factor theme	momentum (4 of 6 universes), WML (2 of 6 universes)
Nearest library signals (returns)	Near 52-week high (6 universes), Residual momentum (4 universes), 55-day breakout (2 universes)
Economic rationale	Behavioural: investors under-react to news and then herd (Barberis, Shleifer & Vishny 1998; Hong & Stein 1999); the disposition effect slows the price response (Grinblatt & Han 2005). Risk stories exist but explain little.
Publication	Jegadeesh & Titman 1993 (data to 1989); Carhart 1997 factor; known crash risk after market rebounds (Daniel & Moskowitz 2016)
Where it fits	In the momentum cluster of the library; with some information beyond its neighbours.

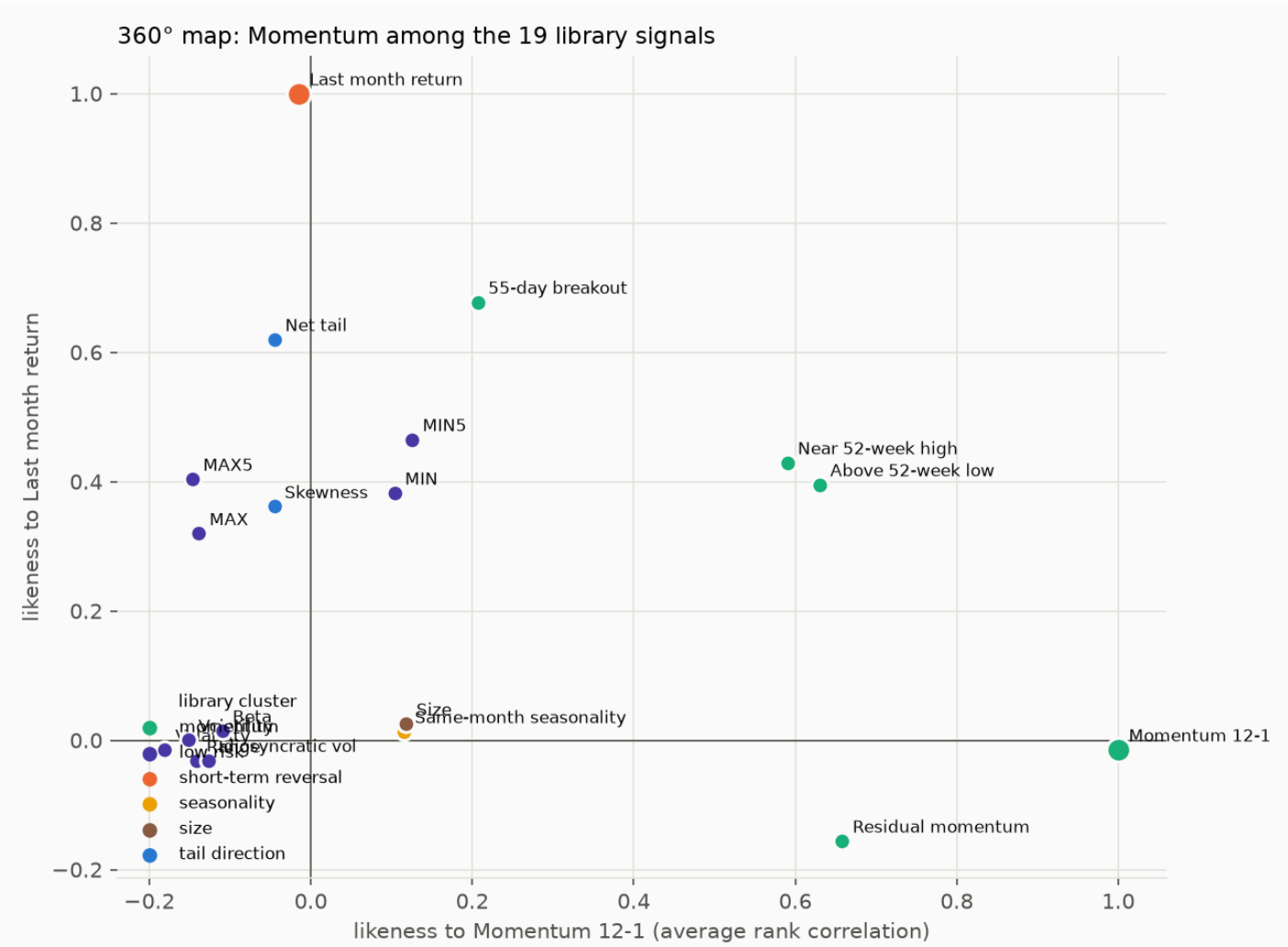


12. 360° view

The signal among the 19 price signals of the shared library (`code/library.py`), on the same universes and months (equal-weighted top minus bottom quantile, gross). Its natural mirror here is **Last month return**.

Signal (top minus bottom, raw sign)	Cluster	Likeness: stocks	Likeness: returns	Raw L/S, avg of 6	CAPM alpha range	Universes alpha $t \geq +2 / \leq -2$
Momentum 12-1 (this strategy)	momentum	+1.00	+1.00	+7.2%	+4.3% to +19.4%	5 / 0
Near 52-week high	momentum	+0.59	+0.80	+3.7%	+9.3% to +22.3%	6 / 0
Residual momentum	momentum	+0.66	+0.64	+6.4%	+8.0% to +12.2%	6 / 0
Above 52-week low	momentum	+0.63	+0.60	+7.5%	+5.2% to +13.6%	4 / 0
55-day breakout	momentum	+0.21	+0.58	+1.4%	+4.1% to +13.0%	4 / 0
Volatility	low risk	-0.18	-0.54	+1.1%	-13.7% to -7.9%	0 / 5
MIN5	low risk	+0.13	+0.52	-0.9%	+2.3% to +13.7%	4 / 0
Volatility (252 days)	low risk	-0.15	-0.50	+2.4%	-12.9% to -4.8%	0 / 3
Range (MAX–MIN)	low risk	-0.14	-0.50	-0.7%	-15.4% to -4.8%	0 / 4
Beta	low risk	-0.11	-0.47	+4.4%	-12.6% to -4.2%	0 / 4
MIN (worst day)	low risk	+0.10	+0.47	-0.7%	+3.3% to +11.1%	4 / 0
MAX (best day)	low risk	-0.14	-0.42	+0.1%	-13.3% to -2.0%	0 / 2
Idiosyncratic vol	low risk	-0.13	-0.42	-3.6%	-15.5% to -4.8%	0 / 4
MAX5	low risk	-0.15	-0.41	+0.6%	-11.3% to -3.5%	0 / 2
Size	size	+0.12	+0.33	+0.1%	-3.8% to +9.9%	1 / 0
Last month return (mirror)	short-term reversal	-0.01	+0.33	+1.8%	-3.2% to +11.0%	2 / 0
Same-month seasonality	seasonality	+0.12	+0.14	-1.9%	-9.4% to +6.6%	0 / 1
Skewness	tail direction	-0.05	-0.10	-0.4%	-6.7% to +3.9%	0 / 2

Signal (top minus bottom, raw sign)	Cluster	Likeness: stocks	Likeness: returns	Raw L/S, avg of 6	CAPM alpha range	Universes alpha $t \geq +2 / \leq -2$
Net tail (MAX+MIN)	tail direction	-0.04	+0.06	-0.9%	-5.2% to +5.2%	0 / 0



Spanning. Regressing the L/S on its five closest library neighbours (by return correlation) and the market:

Universe	Alpha after neighbours / yr	t	R ²	Neighbours with $ t \geq 2$
US	-2.7%	-1.48	0.89	Near 52-week high +0.71 (+7.5), Size +0.41 (+5.4), 55-day breakout -0.35 (-4.0), Above 52-week low +0.35 (+5.5), Residual momentum +0.26 (+3.3)
EU	-1.6%	-0.53	0.80	Near 52-week high +1.07 (+9.9), Residual momentum +0.33 (+3.7), MIN5 -0.31 (-2.6)
UK	+7.2%	2.19	0.76	Near 52-week high +1.25 (+9.9), MIN5 -0.38 (-2.2), 55-day breakout -0.28 (-2.3)
DK	-0.2%	-0.07	0.74	Near 52-week high +0.31 (+5.8), Above 52-week low +0.41 (+6.9), Residual momentum +0.41 (+8.8), Size +0.19 (+3.4)
SCANDI	-3.9%	-1.51	0.69	Near 52-week high +0.67 (+9.3), Residual momentum +0.32 (+5.3), Above 52-week low +0.22 (+2.3)
World	+2.4%	1.26	0.90	Near 52-week high +1.17 (+15.4), 55-day breakout -0.26 (-3.0), Residual momentum +0.40 (+5.5), MIN5 -0.25 (-2.9)

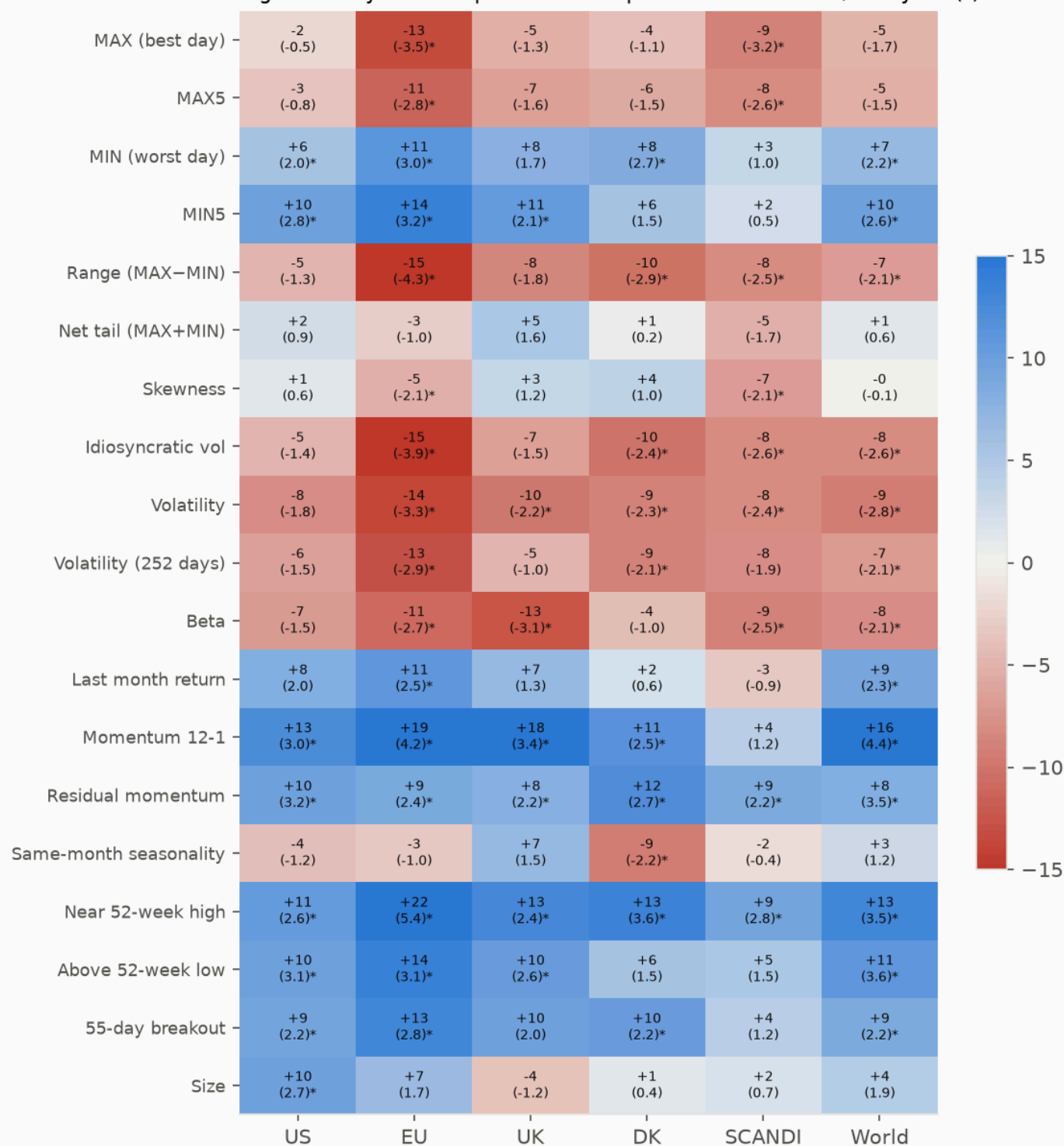
3×3 sort, next-month return a year
(US, EU, UK, SCANDI, World averaged)

low Momentum 12-1	10.9%	9.1%	8.1%
middle	11.1%	11.6%	12.0%
high Momentum 12-1	13.0%	13.8%	13.0%
	low Last month return	middle	high Last month return

Holding Last month return fixed (down a column), moving from low to high Momentum 12-1 changes the return by +2.2, +4.7 and +4.9 points a year; holding Momentum 12-1 fixed (along a row), moving from low to high Last month return changes it by -2.8, +0.9 and +0.0. **Market direction.** Top-minus-bottom return in rising vs falling market months (six-universe average): -4% vs +27% a year. **Horizon:** the gross spread at 1, 2, 3 and 6 months after formation averages +7.2%, +6.4%, +6.6%, +5.9% a year.

The full library, with the CAPM alpha of every signal in every universe:

Signal library: CAPM alpha of each top-minus-bottom sort, % a year (t)



13. Caveats

1. **Residual survivorship.** Point-in-time membership everywhere, but 9–25% of member-quarters outside the US have no price (mostly delisted names); long books are flattered and short books penalised by an unknown amount.
2. **Currency.** Local currency; World sums local-currency returns without conversion.

3. **Equal weighting and flat trading costs.** 10 bp per side for every stock and a size-tiered borrow fee, but no market impact; blue-chip universes only.
4. **Not a registered trial.** Descriptive; the fix ladder is counted inside FSO3–FS12 (25 trials).

14. Academic references

- Jegadeesh, N. & Titman, S. (1993). Returns to buying winners and selling losers. *Journal of Finance*, 48(1), 65–91.
- Carhart, M. (1997). On persistence in mutual fund performance. *Journal of Finance*, 52(1), 57–82.
- Asness, C., Moskowitz, T. & Pedersen, L. H. (2013). Value and momentum everywhere. *Journal of Finance*, 68(3), 929–985.
- Daniel, K. & Moskowitz, T. (2016). Momentum crashes. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 122(2), 221–247.
- Barberis, N., Shleifer, A. & Vishny, R. (1998). A model of investor sentiment. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 49(3), 307–343.
- Hong, H. & Stein, J. (1999). A unified theory of underreaction, momentum trading, and overreaction in asset markets. *Journal of Finance*, 54(6), 2143–2184.
- Grinblatt, M. & Han, B. (2005). Prospect theory, mental accounting, and momentum. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 78(2), 311–339.
- Newey, W. & West, K. (1987). A simple, positive semi-definite, heteroskedasticity and autocorrelation consistent covariance matrix. *Econometrica*, 55(3), 703–708.
- Politis, D. & Romano, J. (1994). The stationary bootstrap. *Journal of the American Statistical Association*, 89(428), 1303–1313.
- Bailey, D. & López de Prado, M. (2012). The Sharpe ratio efficient frontier. *Journal of Risk*, 15(2), 3–44.
- Jensen, T. I., Kelly, B. & Pedersen, L. H. (2023). Is there a replication crisis in finance? *Journal of Finance*, 78(5), 2465–2518.
- Fama, E. & French, K. (2015). A five-factor asset pricing model. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 116(1), 1–22.
- McLean, R. D. & Pontiff, J. (2016). Does academic research destroy stock return predictability? *Journal of Finance*, 71(1), 5–32.
- Novy-Marx, R. & Velikov, M. (2016). A taxonomy of anomalies and their trading costs. *Review of Financial Studies*, 29(1), 104–147.
- Barroso, P. & Santa-Clara, P. (2015). Momentum has its moments. *Journal of Financial Economics*, 116(1), 111–120.
- Moreira, A. & Muir, T. (2017). Volatility-managed portfolios. *Journal of Finance*, 72(4), 1611–1644.
- Treynor, J. & Mazuy, K. (1966). Can mutual funds outguess the market? *Harvard Business Review*, 44(4), 131–136.

15. Reproduce

code/data.py → signals.py, signals2.py, library.py → xs.py + analyse_xs.py FSO3 → build_xs.py FSO3.

Metrics use Project1 InvestmentLibrary. Licensed and cached prices are not included.